



FOREST SPA FOR YOUR
FULL RELAXATION AT
LOPOTA LAKE RESORT & SPA

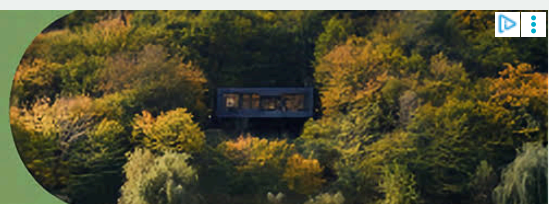


IMAGE CREDITS: DARRELL ETHERINGTON

GAMING



Nintendo raising original Switch console prices due to ‘market conditions’

Aisha Malik — 9:42 AM PDT · August 1, 2025

Nintendo is raising the prices of its original Nintendo Switch game consoles, the [company announced on Friday](#). The price increases, which are taking effect on August 3, are due to “market conditions,” Nintendo says.

The company’s reference to “market conditions” likely hints at [President Donald Trump’s tariffs](#).

The affected products include the Nintendo Switch — OLED Model, Nintendo Switch, Nintendo Switch Lite, and select Nintendo Switch accessories. Other Nintendo products, including certain Nintendo Switch 2 accessories, select amiibo, and the Nintendo Sound Clock: Alarmo, will also see price increases.

It’s not yet clear what the new prices will be. Currently, the original Nintendo Switch retails for \$299.99, while the OLED model costs \$349.99.

Nintendo said it isn’t ruling out a future price hike for the [Nintendo Switch 2](#), which retails for \$450.

“Pricing for the Nintendo Switch 2 system, physical and digital Nintendo Switch and Nintendo Switch 2 games, as well as Nintendo Switch Online memberships, will remain unchanged at this time,” Nintendo wrote in its announcement post. “However, please note that price adjustments may be necessary in the future.”

Earlier on Friday, Nintendo reported its [fiscal first-quarter earnings](#) and shared that sales of the Switch 2 console have reached 5.82 million units since its release on June 5.

Nintendo transferred most of its production from China to Vietnam in the past to [avoid tariffs](#). However, Trump this week announced changes to [reciprocal tariffs](#), which extend to Vietnam.

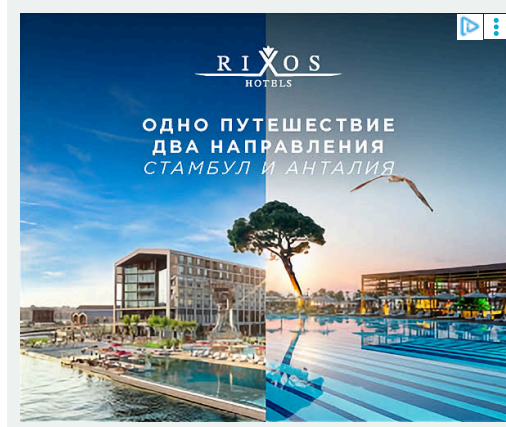


Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital, Elad Gil — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$600+ before prices rise.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW



TC DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

Book Your Table >

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government’s website
- Instagram takes on Snapchat with new ‘Instagram Map’
- Google says hackers stole its customers’ data by breaching its Salesforce database
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about fashion
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines



Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | X butterfly in

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter at MobileSyrup. Aisha holds an honours bachelor’...

View Bio >

KEEP READING

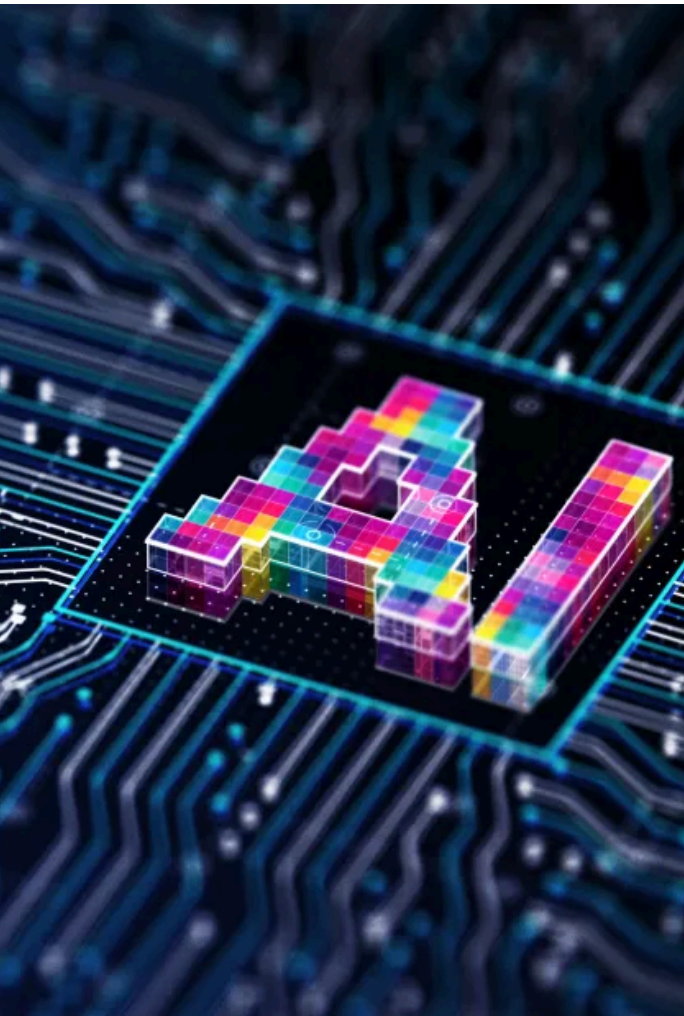


IMAGE CREDITS: BLACKJACK3D / GETTY IMAGES

AI

Two arrested for smuggling AI chips to China — Nvidia says no to kill switches

Rebecca Szkutak — 6:02 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

The U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ) [said](#) on Tuesday that two Chinese nationals have been arrested for their alleged involvement in illegally shipping tens of millions of dollars’ worth of high-performance AI chips to China.

The DOJ said Chuan Geng and Shiwei Yang were arrested in California on August 2 and charged with violating the Export Control Reform Act, a felony that carries a statutory penalty of a maximum of 20 years in prison.

Newsletters [See More ↗](#)

Subscribe for the industry’s biggest tech news

Geng and Yang are accused of knowing and willfully shipping “sensitive technologies,” including GPUs, to China from the U.S. through their California-based company, ALX Solutions.

The DOJ did not name the company whose chips ALX Solutions was allegedly smuggling, but quoting a complaint, it said the chip is “the most powerful chip in the market” and is “designed specifically for AI applications.” That description makes it likely that the chips being smuggled were made by Nvidia. A [report by Reuters](#) specifically named Nvidia’s H100 GPUs as the chips being shipped.

A review of export documents by the DOJ found that ALX Solutions sent chips and other tech to shipping and freight-forwarding companies in Singapore and Malaysia, but received payments from entities in Hong Kong and China in return. The department also found records of communication regarding shipping the tech to Malaysia to specifically go around U.S. export restrictions.

“This case demonstrates that smuggling is a nonstarter,” an Nvidia spokesperson said in a statement. “We primarily sell our products to well-known partners, including OEMs, who help us ensure that all sales comply with U.S. export control rules. Even relatively small exporters and shipments are subject to thorough review and scrutiny, and any diverted products would have no service, support, or updates.”

The news comes as the U.S. tries to figure out how to strike a balance between fostering global AI innovation and imposing export restrictions to China, which many in the West perceive to be a major threat in the AI race. The Trump administration’s recently announced [AI Action Plan](#) belabored the importance of having strong export restrictions but was light on details.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital, Elad Gil — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$600+ before prices rise.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

One potential solution to curb chip smuggling that has been suggested by the U.S. government in recent days is to [implement tracking technology into chips](#) to help catch smuggling, but chipmakers are quite opposed to such a move.

TechCrunch Daily News

Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch’s coverage.

Startups Weekly

Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

TechCrunch Week in Review

Get the best of our coverage, delivered to your inbox every Saturday.

TechCrunch Mobility

TechCrunch Mobility is your destination for transportation news and insight.

No newsletters selected.

Email address

Subscribe

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).

Advertisement

In a [blog post on Tuesday](#), Nvidia said its GPUs do not include kill switches or backdoors, and argued that building in such tools would only result in compromising security.

“Nvidia has been designing processors for over 30 years. Embedding backdoors and kill switches into chips would be a gift to hackers and hostile actors,” the company wrote. “It would undermine global digital infrastructure and fracture trust in U.S. technology. Established law wisely requires companies to fix vulnerabilities — not create them.”

“That’s not sound policy. It’s an overreaction that would irreparably harm America’s economic and national security interests,” Nvidia wrote.

Nvidia did not immediately return requests for additional comment.

For more on the semiconductor industry’s tumultuous year so far, here’s a [regularly updated timeline](#) of market news since the beginning of 2025.

Topics: [AI](#) [AI chips](#) [chips](#) [Enterprise](#) [nvidia](#) [semiconductor](#)



Rebecca Szkutak

Senior Reporter, Venture | [in](#)

Becca is a senior writer at TechCrunch that covers venture capital trends and startups. She previously covered the same beat for Forbes and the Venture Capital...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING

Tinder explores a redesign, dating 'modes,' and college-specific features to boost engagement

Ivan Mehta — 6:40 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Tinder is still struggling to generate revenue from its users, as it reported a 7% dip in paying users while its parent company, Match Group, saw a 5% dip in Q2 2025 across all dating apps, including Tinder, Hinge, Match.com, and others.

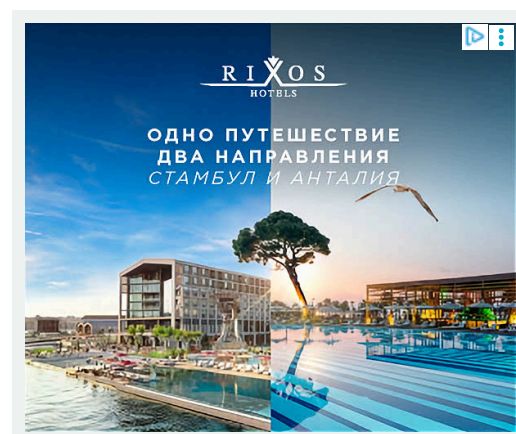
To boost engagement and push more people to pay for its product, the company has undertaken multiple new initiatives. During Match's second-quarter earnings call, Match Group CEO Spencer Rascoff said that Tinder will debut a new feature called "modes," which will allow users to switch between different dating goals to explore new connections in real time. This is similar to a previous option where Tinder allowed users to put their [relationship goals directly on their profiles](#).

Tinder will also explore a broader redesign and other new features, including those aimed at college students, to drive more usage among Gen Z.

Another new feature allows users to like specific parts of a profile, nudging people to start conversations based on those likes, similar to Match's dating app Hinge.

The changes arrive amid a mixed quarter for the dating app giant, which [reported](#) flat year-over-year revenue of \$864 million and earnings that declined from \$133.3 million year-over-year to \$122.5 million in Q2. However, the company provided a better-than-expected Q3 outlook with revenue reaching \$910-920 million, which boosted its stock post-earnings.

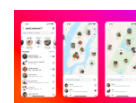
Match also announced it would invest \$50 million in product development, as the dating app maker aims to connect with younger



Latest in Apps

[See More](#)

APPS



How to use Instagram Map and set your location-sharing preferences

Aisha Malik - 2 hours ago

AI



AI agents aren't the 'new Google,' says Airbnb CEO

Sarah Perez - 6 hours ago

APPS



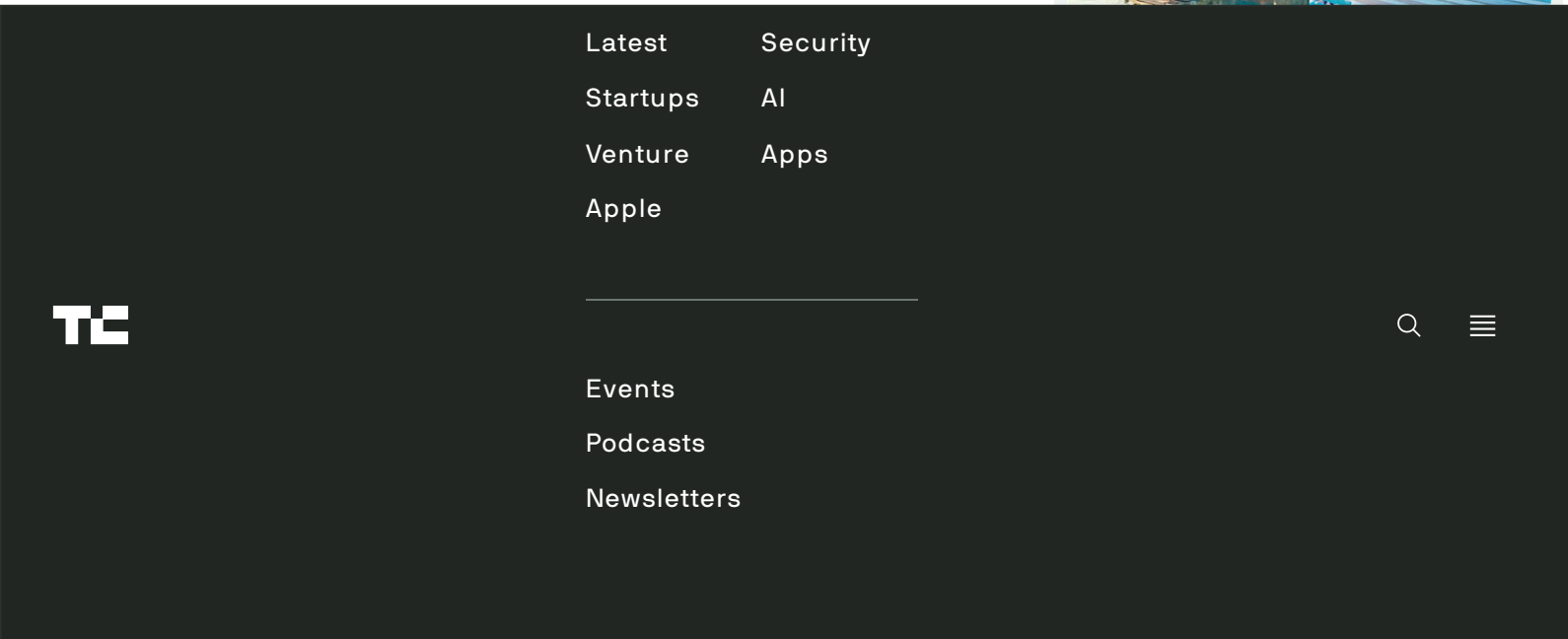
The backlash against Duolingo going 'AI-first' didn't even matter

Amanda Silberling
- 6 hours ago

Gen Z users and use AI to improve its products.

“We’ll take the first steps towards a new UI refresh in Q3 with a cleaner, faster, and more modern look across the entire app,” Rascoff said. “We’re on track to test version one of a redesigned ‘see who likes you’ tab this fall with the goal of helping users connect with people they’re more likely to be interested in, as well as to drive more revenue,” he added.

In the case of the latter, Tinder continues to experiment with [AI-powered](#)



college-specific features, including allowing users to just search within their college or other selected colleges, to appeal to younger users.

The company also offered an update on Tinder’s [Double Date option](#), launched in June, that lets users pair up with a friend to match with another couple. The dating company said it saw positive results with 92% of users utilizing the feature being under 30.

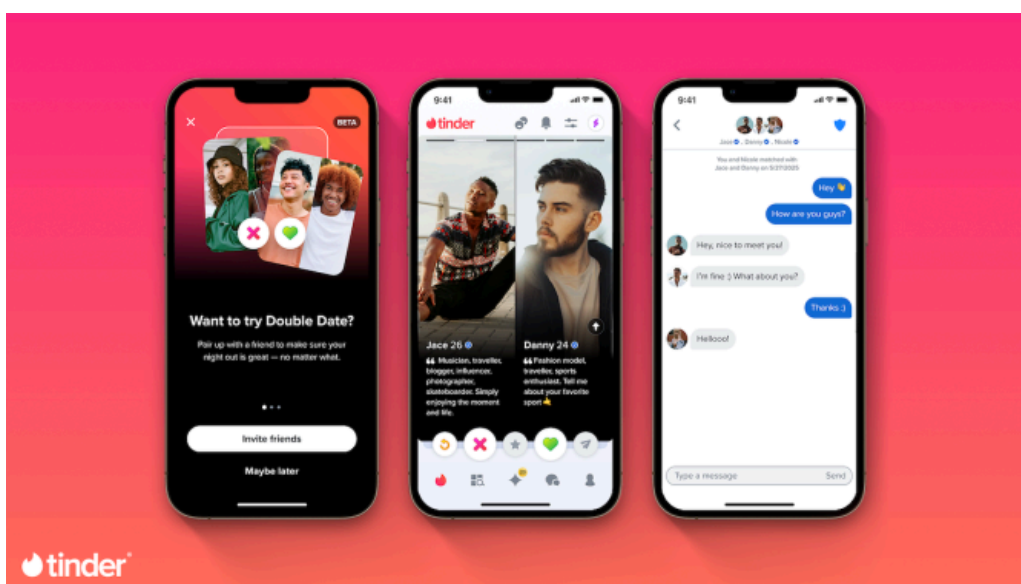


IMAGE CREDITS: TINDER

This was Rascoff’s first full quarter at the helm of Match Group, as the Zillow Group co-founder and Match board member was [appointed](#) CEO in February.

Earlier this year, the company announced that Faye losotaluno would step down from the app’s CEO position in July, with Rascoff taking on the role. The company also laid off 13% of its staff (around 325 people) in May, and [closed open roles](#).

Topics: [Apps](#) [dating apps](#) [Match Group](#) [Social](#) [Tinder](#)



[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [g](#) [e](#) [l](#)



Ivan Mehta
[X](#) [in](#)

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously worked at publications including Huffington Post and The...

[View Bio](#) >

———— KEEP READING ————

GAMING

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [g](#) [e](#) [l](#)

Mastercard denies
pressuring game platforms,
Valve tells a different story

The outcry after a recent marketplace crackdown on games with adult content, seemingly due to pressure from payment processors, prompted Mastercard to release [a brief statement](#) Friday pushing back against recent headlines.

“Mastercard has not evaluated any game or required restrictions of any activity on game creator sites and platforms, contrary to media reports and allegations,” the company said, adding, “At the same time, we require merchants to have appropriate controls to ensure Mastercard cards cannot be used for unlawful purchases, including illegal adult content.”

The group also sent [an open letter](#) by the advocacy group Collective Shout to companies such as PayPal, Mastercard, Visa, and other payment processors, accusing them for allowing the sale of “No Mercy” and other games that depict rape, incest, and child sexual abuse.

IMAGE CREDITS:
ROBERTO MACHADO NOA/LIGHTROCKET / GETTY IMAGES

In the following weeks, Steam announced that it would ban games that violate the rules of its “payment processors and related card networks and banks.” Then [Itch.io](#) said it was [removing games with adult content](#) from its browse and search pages while conducting a broader audit.

While Mastercard’s statement seems to undermine the narrative that payment and card companies were the ones pressuring the game marketplaces, Steam owner Valve responded with a statement of its own, [provided to PC Gamer](#) and other gaming sites.

According to Valve, “Mastercard did not communicate with Valve directly, despite our request to do so. Mastercard communicated with payment processors and their acquiring banks. Payment processors communicated this with Valve, and we replied by outlining Steam’s policy since 2018 of attempting to distribute games that are legal for distribution.”

Valve said its response was “rejected” by the payment processors, who noted the “risk to the Mastercard brand” and pointed to a Mastercard rule against “illegal or brand-damaging transactions.”

TE

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital, Elad Gil — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth



TE DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular



- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government’s website
- Instagram takes on Snapchat with new ‘Instagram Map’
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about

and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$600+ before prices rise.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

fashion

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

Meanwhile, Itch.io said that it's now [re-indexing free games with adult content](#) while negotiating with payment processors, including Stripe, which for its part said it's "unable to support sexually explicit content" due to "banking partners."

Topics: [Gaming](#) [Government & Policy](#) [itch.io](#) [mastercard](#)

[Media & Entertainment](#) [Steam](#) [Valve](#)



Facebook Twitter LinkedIn Email Print



Anthony Ha

in

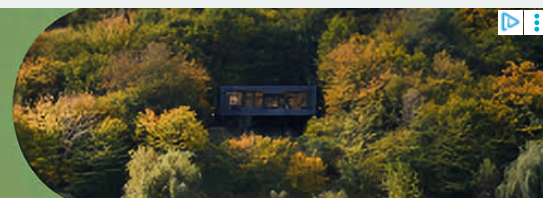
Anthony Ha is TechCrunch's weekend editor. Previously, he worked as a tech reporter at Adweek, a senior editor at VentureBeat, a local government reporter at t...

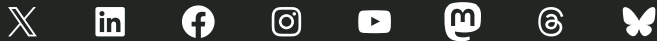
View Bio >

Loading the next article



FOREST SPA FOR YOUR
FULL RELAXATION AT
LOPOTA LAKE RESORT & SPA





[TechCrunch](#)

[Staff](#)

[Contact Us](#)

[Advertise](#)

[Crunchboard
Jobs](#)

[Site Map](#)

[Terms of Service](#)

[Privacy Policy](#)

[RSS Terms of Use](#)

[OpenAI](#)

[Perplexity](#)

[Cisco](#)

[DeepMind](#)

[Windsurf](#)

[Tech Layoffs](#)

[ChatGPT](#)